Glossary

consideration – careful thought

prevalent – common

cripples – people with some disability preventing them from performing certain normal functions

agony – extreme physical and mental suffering

perforated – torn and damaged with holes

ennobles – (figurative use) makes dignified, morally noble

thrash around (idiom) – to move about restlessly

sophisticated – (here) well-advanced

mutilating surgery – surgery involving removal of tissue even at the risk of worsening of the patient's condition

Grand Prix – (here) one of several international motor-racing events

solace – comfort or consolation in times of grief or pain

intrepid – bold and daring

finale – climax or an exciting end

disfigured – spoiled or marred in appearance

malignant – (here, of diseases) very harmful to life

tumour – diseased growth in some part of the body

amputated – cut off by surgical operation

profound – very great

1. Answer the following questions in one or two sentences based on your understanding of the lesson.

a. What thoughts troubled Dr. Christiaan Barnard as he neared the end of his career as a heart surgeon?

b. What were Dr. Barnard's feelings when he was hospitalized after an accident?

c. When and where did the accident occur?

d. How did the hospitalization of Dr. Barnard and his wife affect their routine?

e. How was Dr. Barnard's attitude to suffering different from that of his father's?

f. How was the unattended trolley put to use?

g. What roles did the duo take up?

h. Why did the choice of roles prove to be easy for them?

i. Who encouraged them and how?

j. What does Dr. Barnard compare this entertainment to?

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